

Snippets

NDMC buildings to generate 12MW solar power

Government buildings, covered under NDMC, are going to have roof-top solar plants, which are expected to generate up to 12MW solar power in the next three years. The confirmation about the power-generation capacity came from NDMC area MP Meenakshi Lekhi. As told to PTI, the target is to generate 12MW power through roof-top solar panels and the entire process may take around three years. The first 1MW power generation capacity is possible to be achieved by October-November. This roof-top-panels-generated power will be transferred to the main power grid. Lekhi also admitted that the requirement of this area is much more than the targeted quantity. But still if this target is achieved then it will contribute to the requirement to a large extent and the total cost will also be subsidised.

Google, Airtel bring carrier billing system in India

Google and Airtel have entered into discussions for bringing carrier billing support in Google Play. According to recent reports, Google is in talks with Airtel for developing a platform for Android users, through which the payment for apps and other content in Google Play could be included in their monthly bill instead of them making payments using credit cards.

5th US-India Energy Partnership Summit focuses on cooperation

Organised by the Energy and Resources Institute (TERI) and Yale University, the 5th US-India Energy Partnership Summit focused on pathways to accelerate the growth and development of sustainable energy partnerships. It emphasised on financing clean energy projects and cooperation between the private sector and government, even as business and policy leaders from both countries discussed avenues for increasing cooperation.

Rolta Group ventures into Indian solar energy market

Rolta Group's unit, Rolta Power Pvt Ltd, announced that the company is foraying into the solar power sector. In Mumbai, they have installed a 60MW production line for solar photovoltaic or PV modules. The plant also started production this month.

The smartphones are expected to cost around ₹ 10,000 and use a MediaTek processor. The other details are kept under the wraps.

Philips splits into two

The 120-year-old Dutch company is separating into two parts—the healthcare-lifestyle section is splitting from the lighting business. This is a huge streamlining move at the company's end.

As per PTI, Frans Van Houten, CEO, Philips, informed that Philips is getting ready for the next century. He said that since now the lighting solutions business is independent, they will be in a better position to expand their global leadership and explore more exciting market opportunities. Houten is pretty confident about the decision and its timing. Immediately after the announcement, Philips shares went up by 3.26 per cent to \$31.23. Both divisions will use the Philips name.

The companies will be headquartered in the Netherlands. The restructuring of the company will increase the savings of the company on a whole in next two years.

Nokia suspends its manufacturing operations in India

Nokia has announced its decision to discontinue its manufacturing operations in the country. The mobile company is suspending its operations at its Sriperumbudur plant in Chennai, which once had over 8000 employees, and presently has 1200-1500 on its rolls.

This plant was not even part of Nokia-Microsoft deal, which was finalised in April, owing to the 210,000 million tax claim, because of which the IT department had declined the permission for the plant to be transferred till the dues get cleared.

Microsoft has emphasised on the termination of Nokia and Microsoft transitional services agreement from November 1, 2014, as per which it was decided to keep the factory working. However, Nokia will now suspend the services without any orders from Microsoft.

The company noted that it was try-

ing to diminish the impact of it over the employees as far as possible and had even informed about the suspension to the labour commissioner. A. Soundararajan, general secretary, Centre of Indian Trade Unions, said that the company's decision is illegal and that they had cleverly used the word suspension, which does not require government approval.

NIELIT takes forward National Digital Literacy Mission and Digital India Campaign

Taking forward the National Digital Literacy Mission and Digital India Campaign of the government of India, the National Institute of Electronics and Information Technology (NIELIT), a body with the Department of Electronics and Information Technology (DeitY), Ministry of Communications & IT, government of India, has entered into an MoU with Intel India to jointly conduct courses and online examinations on digital literacy as well as vet NIELIT's courses on electronic system design and manufacturing (ESDM). Intel will develop the software for assessment of candidates under the National Digital Literacy Mission to make the courses more industry-oriented to endeavour to make one member of each household digitally literate in India. The MoU was signed by Dr Ashwini Kumar Sharma, managing director, NIELIT, with Debjani Ghosh, managing director, Intel, South Asia, in the presence of chief guest Ravi Shankar Prasad, minister for Communications & Information Technology and Law & Justice at NIELIT's national level workshop 2014.

Thirty one NIELIT centres are located across the country from Leh in the north to Chennai in the south. The annual workshop on 'Supporting Digital India by Skill, Scaling and Speeding Operations through Public Private Partnerships' explored possible avenues to facilitate the skill-development and capacity-building initiatives of the government of India. NIELIT also entered into an MoU with the Indira Gandhi Delhi Technical University for Women (IGDTUW) on the occasion. Also present were R.S. Sharma, secretary, DeitY, Tapan Ray, additional secretary, DeitY, and Dr Ajay Kumar, joint secretary, DeitY.

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